The Wild Rover

Traditional

Key: **C major** Time: **3/4** Tempo: **120 bpm** Picked: **One string a beat**

Picking to sing along to: the pattern is the accompaniment, the tune is your voice's job.

The pattern

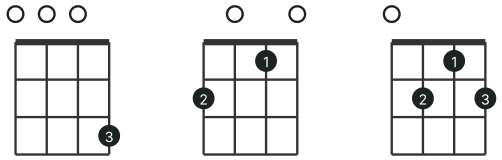
One string a beat `g C E+A`

Thumb, index, middle, ring: one string a beat, from the top string down. The way in: just hold the chord and keep time.

Count	1	&	2	&	3	&
Finger	p	·	i	·	m+a	·
String	g	·	C	·	E+A	·

Fingers: p thumb · i index · m middle · a ring. + means picked together; · is a rest. Hold the whole chord shape and pick from it: every fret number in the tab is already under a finger.

The chords



The song

VERSE 1

```
  C                          F           C
A|--------------------3---------|--------0---|--------3---|
E|--------------------0---------|--------1---|--------0---|
C|----------0--------------------|----0-------|----0-------|
G|0---------------------------|2-----------|0-----------|
  I've been a wild rover for     many's the   year,

  C                       G7                      C
A|----------------3-------|----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  And I've spent all me    money on whiskey and     beer,

  C                 F                 C                 F
A|------------3-----|------------0-----|------------3-----|--------0---|
E|------------0-----|------------1-----|------------0-----|--------1---|
C|------0-----------|------0-----------|------0-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|2-----------------|0-----------------|2-----------|
  But now I'm re     turning with      gold in great     store,
```

```
  C                 G7                      C
A|------------3-----|----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|------------0-----|----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|------0-----------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  And I never will   play the wild rover no   more.
```

CHORUS

```
  G7                            C
A|--------------------2---------|--------------------3---------|
E|--------------------1---------|--------------------0---------|
C|----------2--------------------|----------0--------------------|
G|0-----------------------------|0-----------------------------|
  And it's no, nay, never,       (clap, clap, clap, clap)

  F
A|--------------------0---------|
E|--------------------1---------|
C|----------0--------------------|
G|2-----------------------------|
  No, nay, never, no more,

  C                       F
A|----------------3-------|--------0---|
E|----------------0-------|--------1---|
C|--------0---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------|
  Will I play the wild     rover,

  G7                C
A|------------2-----|--------3---|
E|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|------2-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------|
  No never, no       more.
```

VERSE 2

```
  C                       F            C
A|----------------3-------|--------0---|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|--------1---|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|----0-------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------|0-----------|
  I went to an alehouse I  used to fre  quent,

  C                       G7                  C
A|----------------3-------|------------2-----|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|------2-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|0-----------------|0-----------|
  And I told the land      lady me money was  spent.

  C                 F            C                  F
A|------------3-----|--------0---|------------3-----|--------0---|
E|------------0-----|--------1---|------------0-----|--------1---|
C|------0-----------|----0-------|------0-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|2-----------|0-----------------|2-----------|
  I asked her for    credit, she  answered me "      Nay,
```

```
  C                 G7                      C
A|------------3-----|-----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|------------0-----|-----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|------0-----------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  Such a custom as   yours I could have any   day."
```

CHORUS

```
  G7                            C
A|--------------------2---------|--------------------3---------|
E|--------------------1---------|--------------------0---------|
C|----------2--------------------|----------0--------------------|
G|0-----------------------------|0-----------------------------|
  And it's no, nay, never,       (clap, clap, clap, clap)
```

```
  F
A|--------------------0---------|
E|--------------------1---------|
C|----------0--------------------|
G|2-----------------------------|
  No, nay, never, no more,
```

```
  C                       F
A|----------------3-------|--------0---|
E|----------------0-------|--------1---|
C|--------0---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------|
  Will I play the wild     rover,
```

```
  G7                C
A|------------2-----|--------3---|
E|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|------2-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------|
  No never, no       more.
```

VERSE 3

```
  C                             F           C
A|--------------------3---------|--------0---|--------3---|
E|--------------------0---------|--------1---|--------0---|
C|----------0--------------------|----0-------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------------|2-----------|0-----------|
  I took from me pocket ten      sovereigns   bright,
```

```
  C                       G7                              C
A|----------------3-------|---------------------2---------|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|---------------------1---------|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|----------2--------------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|0-----------------------------|0-----------|
  And the landlady's       eyes opened wide with de       light.
```

```
  C                 F                 C                  F
A|------------3-----|------------0-----|------------3-----|--------0---|
E|------------0-----|------------1-----|------------0-----|--------1---|
C|------0-----------|------0-----------|------0-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|2-----------------|0-----------------|2-----------|
  She said "I have   whiskeys and       wines of the       best,
```

```
  C                       G7                      C
A|----------------3-------|----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  And the words that I     told you were only in    jest."
```

CHORUS

```
  G7                            C
A|--------------------2---------|--------------------3---------|
E|--------------------1---------|--------------------0---------|
C|----------2--------------------|----------0--------------------|
G|0-----------------------------|0-----------------------------|
  And it's no, nay, never,       (clap, clap, clap, clap)
```

```
  F
A|--------------------0---------|
E|--------------------1---------|
C|----------0--------------------|
G|2-----------------------------|
  No, nay, never, no more,
```

```
  C                       F
A|----------------3-------|--------0---|
E|----------------0-------|--------1---|
C|--------0---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------|
  Will I play the wild     rover,
```

```
  G7                C
A|------------2-----|--------3---|
E|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|------2-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------|
  No never, no       more.
```

VERSE 4

```
  C                                   F                 C
A|-------------------------3-----------|------------0-----|--------3---|
E|-------------------------0-----------|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|------------0-----------------------|------0-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------------------|2-----------------|0-----------|
  I'll go home to my parents, con      fess what I've     done,
```

```
  C                       G7                      C
A|----------------3-------|----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|----------------0-------|----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|--------0---------------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  And I'll ask them to     pardon their prodigal    son.
```

```
  C                       F                   C                   F
A|----------------3-------|------------0-----|------------3-----|--------0---|
E|----------------0-------|------------1-----|------------0-----|--------1---|
C|--------0---------------|------0-----------|------0-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------------|0-----------------|2-----------|
  And when they've ca      ressed me as       oft-times be       fore,
```

```
  C                 G7                      C
A|------------3-----|----------------2-------|--------3---|
E|------------0-----|----------------1-------|--------0---|
C|------0-----------|--------2---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------------------|0-----------|
  I never will       play the wild rover no   more.
```

CHORUS

```
  G7                            C
A|--------------------2---------|--------------------3---------|
E|--------------------1---------|--------------------0---------|
C|----------2--------------------|----------0--------------------|
G|0-----------------------------|0-----------------------------|
  And it's no, nay, never,       (clap, clap, clap, clap)

  F
A|--------------------0---------|
E|--------------------1---------|
C|----------0--------------------|
G|2-----------------------------|
  No, nay, never, no more,

  C                       F
A|----------------3-------|--------0---|
E|----------------0-------|--------1---|
C|--------0---------------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------------|2-----------|
  Will I play the wild     rover,

  G7                C
A|------------2-----|--------3---|
E|------------1-----|--------0---|
C|------2-----------|----0-------|
G|0-----------------|0-----------|
  No never, no       more.
```

How to learn it

1. Hold one chord and play the pattern over and over, slowly, until your picking hand does it on its own.
2. Change chords on beat 1: the new shape has to be down by the time your thumb picks.
3. Then the song, slowly (Pick → Play, with the practice speed turned down), up to speed over a few days.
4. Then sing over it. If the words throw your fingers, go back to an easier pattern for a while.

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